

Turtle — User Guide

Turtle is a practice planner that lives entirely in a single HTML file on your computer. Open it in any browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, etc.) and your data is saved automatically — no internet connection, account, or installation required.

The Basics

When you open Turtle you land on the "home screen", which has seven buttons. Each button takes you to a different part of the program. Every sub-screen has a "Back" button in the bottom-left corner to return home.

Your data is saved to the browser automatically every time you make a change. As long as you keep opening the same file in the same browser, nothing will be lost between sessions.

Assignments

An "assignment" is the core unit of the planner. Each one stores:

- "Teacher" — who gave the assignment
- "Task" — a description of what needs to be done
- "Type" — 'Definite' (has a specific due date) or 'Indefinite' (no deadline)
- "Due Date" — day of week, month, and day (only for Definite assignments)
- "Repetition" — how often it recurs: 'Once', 'Daily', or 'Weekly'
- "Estimated Time" — roughly how many minutes the assignment takes in total
- "Importance" — a priority level from 1 (very low) to 5 (very high)
- "Tag" — an optional colour-coded category label (see Tags below)

Adding an Assignment

Go to "Add New Assignment". Fill in all the fields, then click "Add Assignment" at the bottom.

A few things to know:

- If you set Type to 'Indefinite', the due date fields disappear — that's normal.
- Daily and weekly assignments repeat on their own schedule; one-time assignments are tracked until completion.

- You can also "import from a CSV file" (see the CSV section below) to fill the form automatically from a file.
- Once the form is filled, "Export CSV" saves it as a file without adding it to the planner yet — useful for sharing an assignment with someone else.

Tags

Tags are colour-coded labels you can attach to any assignment to help organise them (e.g. "Technique", "Choreography", "Conditioning").

"Creating a tag:" In the Add or Edit form, type a name in the tag name box, pick a colour with the colour picker, and click "+ Add Tag". The tag is created and automatically selected for the current assignment.

"Selecting a tag:" Click a tag chip to select it (it gets a highlighted border). Click it again to deselect. Only one tag per assignment.

"Deleting a tag:" Click the × on any tag chip. Assignments that used it will simply have no tag.

Tags you create are available across all assignments. In "View Assignments", a filter bar appears at the top so you can show only assignments belonging to a specific tag.

Viewing Assignments

"View Assignments" shows all your assignments as cards. Each card displays everything about that assignment, including a coloured priority badge and a tag label at the bottom.

Clicking a card opens a small popup with an "Export as CSV" button, so you can save any existing assignment as a shareable file.

If you have tags, a filter bar appears at the top — click a tag to show only matching assignments, click it again (or "All") to clear the filter.

Planning Your Day

"Plan Day" generates a recommended practice schedule based on how much time you have available.

1. Enter the number of minutes you have today.
2. Click "Generate Plan".

Turtle works out which assignments are most urgent using a scoring formula that considers deadline proximity, importance, and repetition type. Daily assignments are given a priority boost so they consistently appear first. Weekly assignments are treated as complete for the week once their estimated time is fully logged for that week.

Each assignment in the plan shows its details plus a prominent "Recommended Time" banner at the bottom indicating how many minutes to spend on it today.

> After completing your session, remember to log your time so the planner stays accurate.

Logging Time

"Log Time" records how long you actually spent on an assignment.

1. Select an assignment from the dropdown — a preview card appears so you can confirm you picked the right one.
2. Enter the minutes spent.
3. Click "Log Time".

"One-time assignments" accumulate total time spent until the estimated time is reached.

"Weekly assignments" track time spent 'this week' separately. The counter resets automatically every Monday. You'll see "Time Spent This Week: X / Y minutes" on the card.

"Daily assignments" cannot have time logged against them — they are handled purely by the daily priority boost in the planner.

Editing an Assignment

"Edit Assignment" lets you change any field on an existing assignment.

1. Select the assignment from the dropdown.
2. The form fills in automatically.
3. Make your changes and click "Save Changes".

You can also change the tag here, or create new tags the same way as in the Add form.

Removing an Assignment

"Remove Assignment" permanently deletes an assignment.

1. Select the assignment from the dropdown — a preview card appears so you can confirm.
2. Click "Remove Assignment".

This cannot be undone, so check the preview before confirming.

Backup & Restore

Because Turtle stores data in the browser, it's a good idea to back up regularly, especially before clearing data or switching computers.

"Download Backup" saves a `.json` file containing all your assignments and tags. Keep this somewhere safe.

"Restore Data" loads a previously downloaded backup file, replacing everything currently in the planner.

"Clear All Data" wipes all assignments, tags, and weekly tracking. You will be asked to confirm. This cannot be undone — download a backup first if you want to keep your data.

CSV Import & Export

CSV files let you move individual assignments between instances of Turtle, or pre-create assignments in a spreadsheet.

Importing a CSV

In "Add New Assignment", scroll to the "Or import from a CSV file" section and upload a `.csv` file. Turtle reads it and fills the form automatically — you can review and adjust before clicking Add Assignment.

Exporting a CSV

- "From the Add form:" Fill in the fields, then click "↓ Export CSV". The file downloads and the form clears.

- "From View Assignments:" Click any assignment card, then click "↓ Export as CSV" in the popup.

CSV Format

Each file represents a single assignment with one header row and one data row:

...

teacher,task,type,due_day_of_week,due_month,due_day,repitition,time,importance,tag,tag_color,time_spent

Ms Smith,Pirouette drill,definite,Fri,Jun,6,once,30,4,Technique,#e74c3c,0

...

Column	Required	Notes
---	---	---
`teacher`	Yes	Any text
`task`	Yes	Any text
`type`	Yes	`definite` or `indefinite`
`repitition`	Yes	`once`, `daily`, or `weekly`
`time`	Yes	Positive whole number (minutes)
`importance`	Yes	1 to 5
`due_day_of_week`	If definite	`Sun` `Mon` `Tue` `Wed` `Thu` `Fri` `Sat`
`due_month`	If definite	`Jan` `Feb` ... `Dec`
`due_day`	If definite	1 to 31
`tag`	Optional	Tag name; created automatically if new
`tag_color`	Optional	Hex colour e.g. `#e74c3c`; used only if the tag is new
`time_spent`	Optional	Minutes already logged; defaults to 0

If a tag with the same name already exists in your planner, its stored colour is kept — the `tag\_color` in the file is ignored.

Tips

- "Plan first, then log." Generate your plan at the start of a session and log your actual time at the end.
- "Use importance honestly." The planning algorithm weighs importance heavily — reserving 4 and 5 for genuinely critical assignments gives better results.
- "Back up before big changes." Removing assignments or clearing all data is permanent. A quick backup download takes seconds.
- "Tags help filter and focus." If you have many assignments, tags make it easy to see only what's relevant (e.g. "what do I have for Choreography this week?").

- "Weekly assignments reset on Monday." If you log 20 minutes on a weekly assignment on Sunday, it will show 0 again on Monday — that's intentional.